

1 FOREIGN AFFAIRS MANUAL – POLITICALLY RELEVANT REDLINES

2 Source: *_REDLINE_TRACKED.docx files only (17 of 19 volumes have redlines; 16FAM/19FAM excluded, no BEFORE capture)

3 Comparison window: Jan 19, 2025 -> Aug 3, 2026

4 Legend: [[DEL:x]] = struck in tracked changes; [[INS:x]] = inserted in tracked changes

5 Selection: keyword-triaged from 14,347 changed paragraphs (316 flagged), manually curated to the substantively political subset below.

6

7 =====

8 1. SEX MARKER ON VISAS TIED TO "BIOLOGICAL SEX AT BIRTH" (9 FAM)

9 =====

10 f. Passports that do not list male or female: The sex reflected on any issued visa [[DEL:should]][[INS:must]] match the [[INS:visa holder's biological]] sex [[DEL:reflected]][[INS:at birth, even if it differs from the sex listed]] on the [[DEL:passport produced by an issuing authority.]][[INS:passport.]] In those instances where a passport does not list a "male" or "female" [[INS:in the sex]] field, [[INS:you must list]] the [[DEL:applicant must select either male or female for]][[INS:applicant's biological sex at birth on the]] visa [[DEL:issuance.]][[INS:application.]]

11

12 – Converts a discretionary/applicant-selected standard to a mandatory biological-sex-at-birth standard for visa issuance, including for holders of X/unspecified-sex passports.

13

14 =====

15 2. "GENDER" -> "SEX" SUBSTITUTED THROUGHOUT ADOPTION & CONSULAR RECORDS (8, 9, 10 FAM)

16 =====

17 09FAM: "there are any specific restrictions to the adoption such as a child's age, [[DEL:gender,]][[INS:sex,]] or other characteristics."

18 09FAM: "you should assume that there are no age- or [[DEL:gender-related]][[INS:sex-related]] restrictions on which children may be adopted"

19 09FAM: "the I-600A with its approval stamp does not note restrictions on the age or [[DEL:gender]][[INS:sex]] of the adopted child"

20 09FAM: "child must meet all criteria specified in the Form I-800-A approval (age, [[DEL:gender,]][[INS:sex,]] special needs, if any)"

21 08FAM (Sessions v. Morales-Santana discussion): "the constitutionality of INA Section 309 and its differing requirements based on the [[DEL:gender]][[INS:sex]] of the unmarried citizen parent... the statute does not discriminate on the basis of [[DEL:gender]][[INS:sex]] by requiring a citizen father..."

22 10FAM: "Issues resulting from differences of race, ethnicity, [[DEL:gender,]][[INS:sex]] religion, geography, socio-economic status..."

23 07FAM: "anthropologists can also assist by providing information on general age, [[DEL:gender,]][[INS:sex,]] physical size, color of hair, color of eyes, and race"

24 03FAM: "adverse impact on the hiring, promotion, or other employment of individuals, by virtue of their race, color, religion, [[DEL:gender or sexual orientation,]][[INS:sex,]] national origin..."

25

26 – Consistent, cross-volume terminology substitution replacing "gender" with "sex" in legal/biographical/adoption contexts.

27

28 =====
29 3. REMOVAL OF "SEXUAL ORIENTATION" AND "GENDER IDENTITY" FROM EEO PROTECTED CLASSES (2, 3, 11 FAM)
30 =====
31 02FAM (EEO protected basis definition, appears 2x identically):
32 "Race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy, [[DEL:sexual orientation, and gender identity)],][[INS:sex;]] na
tional origin..."
33
34 03FAM (Foreign Service personnel nondiscrimination clause, appears 2x near-identically):
35 "administered without discrimination on the basis of race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy [[DEL:, sexua
l orientation , and gender identity)]][[INS:)]], national origin, age..."
36
37 03FAM (harassment policy, gutted and replaced with unrelated gift-giving/retaliation content):
38 "[[DEL:a. The Department of State is committed to providing a workplace]][[INS:(h) Giving gifts or leaving object
s]] that [[DEL:is free from discriminatory harassment. Employees must not harass anyone because of race, color, re
ligion, sex (including pregnancy, sexual orientation, and gender identity), national origin, age (40 years or olde
r), disability, or genetic information...]][[INS:are sexually suggestive;]]"
39
40 03FAM (SES/merit staffing nondiscrimination, appears 2x): "does not retaliate or discriminate in employment on the
basis of race, color, religion, sex (including [[DEL:pregnancy and gender identity)],][[INS:pregnancy))] national
origin, political affiliation, [[DEL:sexual orientation,]] marital status..."
41
42 03FAM (open assignment system): "This prohibits any consideration on the basis of race, color, religion, sex (incl
uding [[DEL:pregnancy, gender identity, and sexual orientation)],][[INS:pregnancy)],] national origin, age, disabili
ty..."
43
44 03FAM (complaint filing basis): "religion, age, color, race, sex, national origin, [[DEL:sexual orientation,]] dis
ability, or reprisal"
45
46 03FAM (disciplinary-action influence clause, appears 2x): "must in no way be influenced by the employee's race, co
lor, religion, sex, national origin, marital status, disability, political opinions or affiliations, [[DEL:sexual
orientation,]] or [[DEL:gender identity.]][[INS:sex.]]"
47
48 11FAM (advisory committee note deleted entirely): "[[DEL:NOTE: Other Department policies or applicable law may inc
lude other prohibited grounds of discrimination, including but not limited to sexual orientation and gender identi
ty. See e.g., 3 FAM 1500.]]"
49
50 11FAM (advisory committee selection): "selected without regard to national origin, religion, race, sex, [[DEL:sexu
al orientation,]] color..." [Note: term struck but full sentence context shows partial retention elsewhere – flagg
ed as inconsistent application]
51
52 – "Sexual orientation" and "gender identity" struck as protected EEO categories across at least 9 separate personn
el-policy provisions in 3 volumes.
53
54 =====
55 4. "LGBTQI+/LGBTI" NARROWED TO "LGB" – TRANSGENDER & INTERSEX DROPPED (1, 7, 9 FAM)

56 =====

57 01FAM: title of position "1 FAM [[DEL:513 special envoy]][[INS:513 Senior Advisor]] to [[DEL:advance]] the [[DEL:h
human rights of lgbtqi+ persons]][[INS:Assistant Secretary]]" – Special Envoy to Advance the Human Rights of LGBTQI
+ Persons position retitled to a generic Senior Advisor to the Assistant Secretary.

58

59 01FAM (PRM populations of concern): "protection from sexual exploitation and abuse [[DEL:(PSEA) and gender-based v
iolence (GBV),]][[INS:(PSEA),]]... women and children, [[DEL:LGBTQIA+]][[INS:LGB]] individuals, persons with disab
ilities..."

60

61 07FAM (threat/travel-risk coordination, 4 instances): "such as [[DEL:LGBTQI+LGBTI]][[INS:LGB]] issues"; "specific
to certain groups, such as [[DEL:LGBTQI+]][[INS:LGB]] travelers"; "such as [[DEL:LGBTQI+ issue;]][[INS:LGB issue
s;]]"; "(required if [[DEL:LGBTQI+]][[INS:LGB]] language is other than the standard text)"

62

63 07FAM (prisoner welfare): "A [[DEL:LGBTQI+]][[INS:LGB]] partner of the prisoner who was in a civil union..."; "Xen
ophobia, racism, prejudice, [[DEL:LGBTQI+-related]][[INS:LGB-related]] issues"

64

65 09FAM (refugee referral guidance): "a well-known journalist, or lesbian, [[DEL:gay, bisexual, transgender, or inte
rsex (LGBTI)]][[INS:gay or, bisexual (LGB)]] individual or advocate... who has fled to avoid arrest or has been th
reatened"

66

67 09FAM (section title deleted): "9 FAM 102.8-1(H) [[DEL:Transgender Marriages]][[INS:Legal Separations and Marriage
Termination]]" – a subchapter specifically addressing recognition of transgender marriages is retitled and, per th
e AFTER document, repurposed to a different topic.

68

69 – Every instance of "LGBTQI+/" "LGBTI" in the redlined volumes was narrowed to "LGB," consistently removing transge
nder and intersex from protected/covered categories in human rights, refugee-protection, and consular-welfare cont
exts.

70

71 =====

72 5. DEI/DEIA STRIPPED FROM BUREAU MANDATES, HIRING, AND PROGRAM DESIGN (1, 2, 3, 14, 18, 20 FAM)

73 =====

74 01FAM (office management duties, 2 near-identical instances): "[[DEL:ensures diversity, equity and inclusion in al
l office processes consistent with Department policies;]]" – deleted outright, no replacement.

75

76 01FAM (OIG/EX mandate): "responsible for human resources; [[DEL:diversity, equity, inclusion, accessibility, and b
elonging (DEIAB)]] in OIG hiring practices..."

77

78 01FAM (DT/BMP/SWP office mandate, substantially rewritten): "[[DEL:(b) Establish effective DEIA policy, goals, gui
dance, regulations, guidelines, plans, initiatives, and programs to advance and accomplish a diverse, inclusive, t
ransparent, and collaborative work culture for DT and its employees;]]" replaced with workforce-planning language;
"[[DEL:(c) Advise DT leadership... to ensure compliance with DEIA-related Executive Orders...]]" replaced with IT-
recruitment language; "[[DEL:(d) Establish, operate, maintain... DEIA Advisory Council, Employee Affinity Groups,
Department DEIA Working Groups...]]" deleted.

79

80 01FAM: "[[DEL:(f) Human Resources, to include Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Accessibility (DEIA);]][[INS:Resou
rces;]]"; "(c) Human capital, [[DEL:to include DEIA;]]"

81

82 02FAM (school allowance eligible costs): "Costs incurred for [[DEL:Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Programs]][[IN
S:the professional development of the School Board.]]"

83

84 02FAM (EEO Counselor conflict-of-interest list): "such as a [[DEL:FWPC,]][[INS:FWPC or]] union [[DEL:representativ
e, or DEIA council chair)]][[INS:representative)]]"

85

86 03FAM (heading retitled): "3 FAM [[DEL:2841.2-5 Diversity, Equity, Inclusion and Accessibility (DEIA)]][[INS:2841.
2-5 Definitions]]"

87

88 05FAM (citation removed from an EO list – the EO 14035 DEIA citation is struck outright): "Executive Order [[DEL:1
4035:]] Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Accessibility in the Federal Workforce" – appears as a deleted line item
in a list of governing authorities.

89

90 14FAM (federal procurement guidance): "a supplier base dashboard to evaluate progress in achieving [[DEL:diversity
and]] resilience in each agency's supplier base"

91

92 18FAM (program design guidance, substantially gutted): "External factors to assess could include community [[DEL:p
articipation and experiences of marginalized communities;]][[INS:participation,]]... and conditions pertaining to
security, culture, [[DEL:gender equality,]] economy... Consultation with members of impacted [[DEL:groups, includi
ng marginalized populations,]][[INS:groups]]... [[DEL:Analysis tools may include but are not limited to: Community
Participation Analysis Tool [Department Equity Council]; gender analysis of conflict [CSO]; gender, equity, and in
clusion framework [INL]; and intersectional gender analysis [S/GWI]; among others;]]"

93

94 20FAM (data-governance working group eliminated): "[[DEL:The first two EDSWG are the DEIA Data Working group, whi
ch is a collaboration of GTM, M/SS, S/OCR, and S/ODI, and the Strategic Competition Working Group...]]" – DEIA Dat
a Working Group reference deleted; separately, "20 FAM 402.2-3" DEIA Data Dissemination and Usage Policy citation
and the "DEIA Data Working Group" mailbox are struck and replaced with generic access-control language.

95

96 – DEI/DEIA is removed as an organizational value, a hiring criterion, a program-design lens, and a named governanc
e body across at least six volumes.

97

98 =====

99 6. "WOMEN'S EMPOWERMENT AND GENDER EQUALITY" LANGUAGE CUT FROM UN/MULTILATERAL MANDATES (1 FAM)

100 =====

101 "issues relating to human rights, women's empowerment and [[DEL:gender]] equality, and democracy promotion, partic
ularly the Office of the High Commissioner..."

102 "aging, disabilities, indigenous peoples, and women's empowerment and [[DEL:gender]] equality through multilateral
diplomacy..."

103 "successful implementation of reforms to enhance the UN's efforts to promote [[DEL:gender]] equality and the empow
erment of women..."

104

105 – "Gender equality" struck from at least three descriptions of IO/multilateral-affairs bureau responsibilities (th
e word "equality" is retained in some but detached from "gender").

106

107 =====

108 7. NEW "SCHEDULE POLICY/CAREER" PERSONNEL CATEGORY (3 FAM) – SCHEDULE F SUCCESSOR

109 =====

110 "3 FAM 3186 [[DEL:THROUGH 3189 UNASSIGNED]][[INS:Special Provisions for Schedule Policy/Career Employees]]"

111 "[[DEL:The]][[INS:Except as provided in 3 FAM 4740 as applicable to employees in Schedule Policy/Career positions,
the]] Administrative Grievance System described in this chapter does not apply to:"

112 Dated by change transmittal: (CT:PER-1165; 11-30-2023) -> (CT:PER-1222; 03-27-2025)

113

114 – A previously unassigned/reserved section of the FAM is populated with provisions for "Schedule Policy/Career" em
ployees (the 2025 rebrand of the "Schedule F" at-will policy-employee category), and that category is carved out o
f the standard administrative grievance system.

115

116 =====

117 8. EXPANDED IDEOLOGICAL-EXCLUSION (COMMUNIST/TOTALITARIAN PARTY) VISA GUIDANCE (9 FAM)

118 =====

119 New affiliate-party definition inserted under INA 212(a)(3)(D) ideological exclusion ground: "[[INS:defined in 22
CFR 40.34(a) is an organization related to, or identified with, a proscribed party or association... Parties that
are "socialist" in name or political philosophy, or otherwise advocate communist political philosophy such as the
collectivization of private property and the means of production, are an "affiliate" of a communist party... Examp
les of such affiliates include, but are not limited to, the Socialist Unity Party of Germany, the Workers' Party o
f Korea, the Korean Social Democratic Party, and the United Socialist Party of Venezuela.]]"

120

121 Narrowed "essentials of living" exception (harder to qualify for the involuntary-membership exemption to ideologic
al exclusion): "[[INS:Examples of the essentials of living refer to food rations, shelter, clothing, and employmen
t at the minimum level routinely available to the rest of the population, and only if the alien participated only
to the minimal extent necessary to receive these essentials of living. Benefits beyond those minimally and routine
ly available to the rest of the population are not "essentials of living" for purposes of this exception.]]"

122

123 – Substantial new text expanding which foreign parties count as "communist/totalitarian" affiliates for visa ineli
gibility purposes (naming Venezuela's ruling party specifically), and narrowing the humanitarian exception to that
ineligibility ground.

124

125 =====

126 9. DELETED REPRODUCTIVE-HEALTH ADVISORY FOR SEXUAL-ASSAULT VICTIMS (7 FAM)

127 =====

128 "[[DEL:(2) Advise the victim that certain rape treatments may induce abortion.]]" – replaced with generic referral
language ("identify additional resources... referral to specialized services for sexual assault victims").

129

130 – Guidance instructing consular officers to inform sexual-assault victims abroad that emergency treatment may indu
ce abortion is deleted outright, not merely reworded.

131

132 =====

133 10. LOWER-CONFIDENCE / STRUCTURAL ITEMS (included for completeness, less clearly partisan)
134 =====
135 - Bureau of Global Talent Management (GTM) renamed to "HR" throughout 3 FAM personnel provisions (e.g., "GTM/CSTM"
-> "PERT/CSTM"; "GTM" -> "HR"), consistent with a State Dept. HR-bureau reorganization rather than a substantive p
olicy shift.
136 - "Host country"/"host government" replaced with "receiving state"/"government of the receiving state" essentially
everywhere across all 17 redlined volumes – Vienna Convention terminology standardization, not obviously partisan,
but pervasive enough to note.
137 - 01FAM: Special Envoy to Monitor and Combat Antisemitism (J/SEAS) duties renumbered and reorganized – direct "mon
itoring and combating" language shifted toward "coordinating and assisting" in report preparation; net effect on a
uthority unclear from the redline alone.
138 - 01FAM: Nuclear Risk Reduction Center scope description drops the explicit reference to "the Parties of the expir
ed START Treaty the Russian Federation, Belarus, Kazakhstan, and Ukraine," retaining only "the Soviet Union." Ambi
guous whether this reflects START's 2023 suspension/lapse or a broader deprioritization of Ukraine-specific arms-c
ontrol language.
139
140 =====
141 NOTE ON METHOD
142 =====
143 Extraction: parsed word/document.xml of each REDLINE_TRACKED.docx for w:ins/w:del runs (14,347 changed paragraphs
across 17 volumes). Triaged by ~50 politically salient keyword patterns (sex/gender, DEI, immigration/refugee/asyl
um, personnel/Schedule F, ideological exclusion, geopolitics) to 316 candidates, then manually reviewed and curate
d to the above. Purely stylistic/formatting redlines (spacing, citation punctuation, "()" -> "()", etc.) and clea
rly non-political substantive edits (e.g., Marine Corps housing allowance mechanics, UAB shipping weight rules) we
re excluded even where they matched a keyword by coincidence.
144